



ExploreVR 

IT'S EMPLOYMENT

INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

INVITATION TO APPLY STATE LEARNING COLLABORATIVE

PROJECT OVERVIEW

IT'S EMPLOYMENT is a Rehabilitation Services Administration (RSA) funded project designed to improve employment outcomes for individuals with intellectual disabilities (ID) through training of vocational rehabilitation (VR) personnel, including staff who work for state VR agencies, other public systems, and service providers. Led by the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston, this project offers training opportunities including topical modules, a mini-course, an academic rehabilitation counseling course, and a state learning collaborative.

THE STATE LEARNING COLLABORATIVE

The State Learning Collaborative (SLC) offers a customized approach to training for VR agencies and their partners that is designed to enhance the knowledge and strengthen partnerships that are key to the employment success for individuals with ID. The project will support two state learning collaboratives annually. ICI is now inviting applications for these two SLCs. Each participating VR agency and their partners will be asked to identify specific goals for participation in the SLC.

For each participating state the SLC will include:

- » Two days of in-person training, or equivalent (12 to 14 hours) online
- » A six-month, state specific, Community of Practice focused on the state's specific goals

ELIGIBILITY

The state VR agency must be the applicant and each SLC team must include at a minimum the state's intellectual and developmental disability agency as a partner. Additional partners may also be included based on the state's specific goals for improving employment services and outcomes for individuals with intellectual disabilities. The focus of this effort is intended to have impact on a statewide level. If a Tribal VR agency is the applicant, the focus of the SLC will be on the region covered by that agency.

APPLICATION

States must complete the online application by August 20.

KEY APPLICATION DATES

July 27

[Online application available here](#)

August 5

Informational webinar (3-4 ET) hosted by ICI. Overview of the project and opportunity for questions and answers. [Pre-register here](#)

August 20

Application deadline

September 10

Agencies notified on the status of their application

FOR MORE INFORMATION

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IT'S EMPLOYMENT is a project of **ExploreVR** at the Institute for Community Inclusion, UMass Boston. ExploreVR offers VR agencies easy and convenient access to a range of VR research, related data, training and tools for planning, evaluation, and decision-making. Funding for this project is provided by the US Department of Education, Office of Special Education and Rehabilitative Services, Rehabilitation Services Administration, under CFDA 84.263C.